

Physics Lab Report Rubric

Name: _____ ID#: _____

This is a writing course, so **your grade in all sections will be heavily affected by the quality of your writing**. Your report must read well, make sense, and be free of typos and grammatical errors to earn a high score. Avoid overly wordy or colloquial phrasing (simply, basically, in order to, etc.)

For more information refer to the "Guide to Writing Lab Reports"

Dos	Don'ts	Possible	Earned
Abstract			
• DO state physical principle you are testing • DO state main quantitative result including and how it relates to your prediction • DO explain what you did in lab in one or two sentences	• DON'T use more words than necessary (<5 Sentences)	10%	
Introduction			
• DO keep it short! • DO briefly motivate the experiment	• DON'T dive deep into a story or history • DON'T spend too much time on this section	5%	
Prediction			
• DO answer the questions from the lab • DO justify your prediction with physics • DO include equations and graphs where appropriate	• DON'T put equations in line with text	20%	
Procedure			
• DO Briefly explain what was done in the lab • DO explain any factors in your procedure that led to systematic errors	• DON'T give an exhaustive step by step of the setup • DON'T list all the equipment used • DON'T include raw data	5%	
Analysis			
• DO have reasonable error bars on all plots • DO label x and y axes INCLUDING UNITS • DO include fit equations on plots • DO compare your results to predictions • DO explain error and uncertainty quantitatively • DO put equations on their own line and number them	• DON'T show tables of values • DON'T write "human error" • DON'T show numerical calculations • DON'T show every algebraic manipulation • DON'T use qualitative language when it can be replaced with quantification	50%	
Conclusion			
• DO restate your results similarly to the abstract • DO bring it back to the context of the lab • DO compare results to prediction • DO explain how the experiment could have been improved (ONLY if you deviated from prediction) • DO keep it short!	• DON'T regurgitate the abstract • DON'T make claims that are not supported by your experiment	10%	
Total		100%	